



Robocoin

Collect cash

WAVES

WAVES

20

CASH OUT

017 / 29 OCT 2013 / BITCOIN / COMMON

TAP BUY OR SELL.

A customer reaches for a banknote while the coffee machine hums behind her. Outside, the illustrated city is wet and blue; inside, a bright screen lights her face. The surprise is small and immediate: something held in a digital wallet has become cash she can take away. No vault or trading floor is needed, just a new machine in an ordinary coffee shop.

On 29 October 2013, a Robocoin kiosk launched at Waves Coffee House in downtown Vancouver. Operated by Bitcoiniacs, it marked the first permanent public Bitcoin ATM installation. Earlier demonstrations had shown the idea at conferences; this machine put it somewhere people could walk in, order a drink and try it for themselves.

The kiosk worked in both directions. Customers could exchange cash for bitcoin or sell bitcoin and collect cash. A phone reader and a separate palm scanner formed part of its unusual hardware. In a launch interview, Robocoin chief executive Jordan Kelley described the simple choice: tap buy or sell. The woman here demonstrates the cash-out side; she is a fictional customer, not a portrait of the first person to use it.

This moment gave an online currency a familiar physical doorway. The machine did not create bitcoins or turn them into metal coins. It connected a digital balance with a cash transaction, while the cafe around it carried on serving coffee. That ordinary setting is the point of the picture: a new way to exchange money appearing between the counter, the cups and the next person in line.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE BLUE ROBOCOIN

The blue-and-silver cabinet and black screen surround follow contemporary launch photographs. Its readable interface is simplified for the illustration, not a recreation of a documented withdrawal screen.

02 TWO SEPARATE READERS

The red-lit phone reader and green-lit palm scanner are distinct from the cash outlet. They recall the original kiosk's hardware; the cash comes from the slot below the main screen.

03 THE WAVES CUP

The takeaway cup names the coffee-house setting. It is this scene's everyday anchor and a possible recurring object for future HISTROVE artwork, not a claim that this exact cup was photographed at the launch.

04 THE LITTLE KEY

A reporter found the ATM's key on a cafe table during installation the day before launch. The small brass key beside the cup is a callback to that incident; its placement here is invented.

05 CASH IN HAND

The green Canadian-style note makes the exchange visible. The customer, denomination, evening rain and city view are illustrative choices, not a documented first withdrawal or exact reconstruction of the launch.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

CoinDesk's [launch interview](#) records the operator, buy/sell function and Kelley's words. WIRED's [advance report](#) distinguishes the permanent installation from earlier demonstrations; its [launch photographs](#) document the hardware. The [28 October installation report](#) supplies the key anecdote. People, weather, composition, props and screen wording are dramatized. Earlier test use must not be relabelled as the first cash withdrawal.